Zoho Round 1 Preparation Roadmap

Written Test: Aptitude & Programming (Freshers Off-Campus / On-Campus)

1. What Round 1 Actually Looks Like

Zoho's Round 1 is an offline, pen-and-paper written test (no MCQ options in most drives — you write answers directly). It is split into two back-to-back sections:

Section	Content	Typical Time	Difficulty
Section 1 – Aptitude	10–25 questions: quantitative aptitude, logical reasoning, puzzles, number series	45–90 min	Moderate–Hard, no options
Section 2 – Programming	10 questions: mostly 'predict the output' for C/C++/Java code snippets	45–60 min	Moderate–High

Note: exact question count and timing vary slightly by drive/year (on-campus vs off-campus). Always re-check the specific pattern shared in your call letter.

2. Key Facts to Know Before You Start

- No negative marking — attempt every question, even a guess.
- No answer choices for most questions — you must derive and write the exact answer, so guessing from options isn't possible.
- Programming section leans heavily on C — pointers, arrays, loops, recursion, functions, and output-prediction.
- Aptitude questions are logic-heavy, not formula-plug-in — expect puzzles and reasoning over direct formula application.
- Selection into Round 2 (Basic Programming) depends on relative performance — accuracy and speed both matter.

3. 4-Week Preparation Roadmap

Week 1 — Aptitude Foundations

- Number systems, LCM/HCF, percentages, ratio & proportion, averages
- Profit & loss, time & work, time-speed-distance, simple/compound interest
- Practice 15–20 questions/day with a strict timer, no calculator

Week 2 — Logical Reasoning & Puzzles

- Number series, coding-decoding, blood relations, direction sense
- Seating arrangements, syllogisms, logical deduction puzzles
- Start solving previous years' Zoho aptitude papers (Section 1 style)

Week 3 — C Programming Core

- Revise C syntax deeply: pointers, arrays, strings, structures
- Practice tracing code by hand — loops, recursion, switch-case, operator precedence

- Daily drill: 10 'predict the output' snippets, solve on paper (no IDE)

Week 4 — Mock Tests & Timing

- Take 3–4 full-length mock tests replicating the exact Section 1 + Section 2 timing
- Review every wrong answer — classify as concept gap vs. silent mistake
- Final revision: formula sheet + common C output-prediction traps

4. Topic Checklist

Aptitude	Programming (C/C++/Java basics)
Number systems & divisibility	Data types, operators, precedence
Percentages, profit & loss	Loops (for/while/do-while) tracing
Time, speed & distance / work	Arrays & strings
Averages, ratios, mixtures	Pointers & pointer arithmetic
Permutations & probability	Functions, recursion, call stack tracing
Number & letter series	Structures & basic OOP (Java/C++)
Logical puzzles & seating arrangement	Switch-case & control flow output prediction
Blood relations & direction sense	Basic sorting/searching logic (concept level)

5. Exam-Day Strategy

- Attempt the section you're stronger in first if the paper allows moving within a section.
- For output-prediction questions, trace variable values line-by-line on rough paper — don't guess.
- Since there's no negative marking, never leave a question blank.
- Watch the clock: don't let one puzzle eat more than 2–3 minutes; return to it later if stuck.
- Write neatly and show steps — partial working can matter when answers are evaluated manually.

Sources: Zoho fresher recruitment pattern as reported across placement-prep guides and recent candidate interview experiences (2026 drives). Patterns vary by drive — confirm specifics from your official call letter or Zoho careers page.